FRESH TIPS FOR FACEBOOK BEGINNERS

A BEGINNER'S GUIDE TO FACEBOOK ADVERTISING

RESULT-ORIENTED MARKETING & TECHNOLOGY AGENCY

KONTRA

What can we help you with

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Visual Communication Design	Art Direction Design Strategy Branding Photography Video production Packaging UX & UI Digital Desig
Digital Marketing Services	Social Media Marketing Community Management Support Content Writing E-mail Marketing Native Advertising
Development	Web App Development Web Development Ecommerce Development
Other	Education Media Buying Influencer Marketing

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WHY FACEBOOK?

1. WHY FACEBOOK?

Facebook ads are one of the key components of online advertising. According to official statistics, Facebook currently has 3,05 billion active users monthly and is still the most popular social network worldwide. Basically, people all over the globe, from all age groups, use this platform: from pensioners and baby boomers to millennials and even their younger brothers and sisters. One of the best perks of Facebook is almost instant two-way communication, which allows its users to ask questions and get quick responses and all the needed information much faster than via traditional media. The second-best advantage regarding advertising is quality targeting possibilities and choosing target groups to which you want to distribute your ads.

When we discuss social media presence, the question immediately arises: ‘How do we attract users to the Facebook page and communicate with a target audience of the particular brand?’ The answer is through Facebook ads! Thanks to their help, we can find, target, and send a message to a precisely specified target audience to attract users to like the page, communicate with the brand, and, to close it, become customers.

Facebook ads can bring multiple profits if the user who comes to the site by clicking the ad also likes the page itself. Below, we’ll show you how to create and manage Facebook ads and how to optimize them to achieve goals.

INTRODUCTION TO FACEBOOK ADS

2.1. WHY IS FACEBOOK ADVERTISING IMPORTANT?

Facebook ads are one of the most essential tools in successful online advertising. One of its best features is the possibility of instant communication with potential customers, adaptable liabilities for the target audience, and a quality interface for creating. Facebook has 3,05 billion active customers monthly, making it a perfect platform for promoting different services and products to various target customers.

Facebook ads allow precise targeting based on demographic characteristics, different interests on users' profiles, and their preferred way of using Facebook (on mobile phones, computers, etc.). For example, we want to advertise an Android app meant for the population aged 16 to 50 who are interested in sports activities, exercise, cooking, and a healthy lifestyle but who use Facebook mostly on their Android mobile phones. That's precise, right?

Another big plus is the simplicity of developing the creative part of adverts. A short text and an effective picture or photo are quite enough if they are sending out the right message. It attracts a targeted audience to your Facebook page where you're promoting a certain product or leads them to a website. Additional investment in video adverts, banner design, or something similar isn't necessary in this case.

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TYPES OF FACEBOOK CAMPAIGN OBJECTIVES

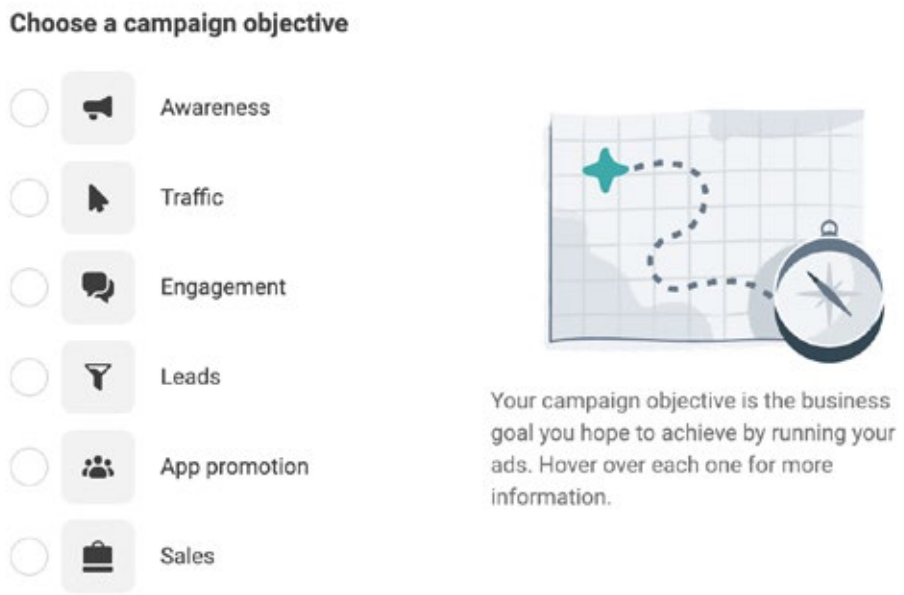
3. TYPES OF FACEBOOK CAMPAIGN OBJECTIVES

It's crucial to align your Facebook ads objective with your business goals when making a choice. The objectives of Facebook are based on algorithmic learning, which means the Facebook algorithm uses patterns in past behaviors to predict future actions.

The objective you choose significantly influences how Facebook algorithms optimize the delivery of your ads. Each objective triggers specific ad optimization mechanisms. For instance, if your goal is to drive website traffic, the Facebook system will prioritize showing your ad to users who are more likely to click through to your website. So, before deciding on a campaign objective, you must consider your business goals.

Whether you're looking to boost brand awareness, drive traffic to your website, or generate leads, your objective sets the tone for your entire campaign.

Let's dive into Facebook ad objectives and see which could improve your performance.



Awareness

Bring awareness to your business. This objective will help you reach the most significant number of people who are most likely to remember your ad.

If your business is brand new or has recently changed names, awareness may help potential customers become more familiar with your company.

Traffic

Increase traffic to an online destination of your choice. This objective aims to drive traffic outside of Facebook, i.e., back to your web shop, website, or app. If you have a new product page or a landing page and want customers to visit them, then this is your objective.

If you're having a flash sale in your shop or want to send potential customers to a web page that describes your services, this may help drive traffic to those destinations.

Decide where your ad clicks go – your website, Messenger, or WhatsApp. Meta then shows your ad to the audience most likely to click, directing them to your chosen spot. There, potential customers can learn more about what you offer, getting closer to a purchase.

Engagement

Find the people most likely to engage with your business online, send a message, or take desired actions on your ad or Page.

Suppose you want people interested in your products or services to start a conversation via Messenger. In that case, this objective can reach potential customers who are more likely to do so.

The engagement campaign objective can help you get more shares, likes, and comments on your ads and posts and get more video views and messages. It can also help you reach people more likely to participate in your events and claim your offers. Every form of interaction with your page can be set to this campaign objective.

Leads

Collect leads for your business or brand via messages, phone calls, or signups.

If you want potential customers to sign up for a monthly newsletter, leads can help you reach people who want to share their information and learn more about your business.

The Facebook Leads objective allows you to reach potential buyers without redirecting them away from Facebook. In other words, instead of directing them to your store, you invite them to provide their contact information or chat with you, allowing you to build your customer base.

For example, you can set up Instant Forms to gather information about interested customers or share fantastic offers.

App promotion

Get people on mobile devices to install or take a specific action within your app. If you want potential customers to purchase through your app or try a new feature, you can create an app promotion campaign.

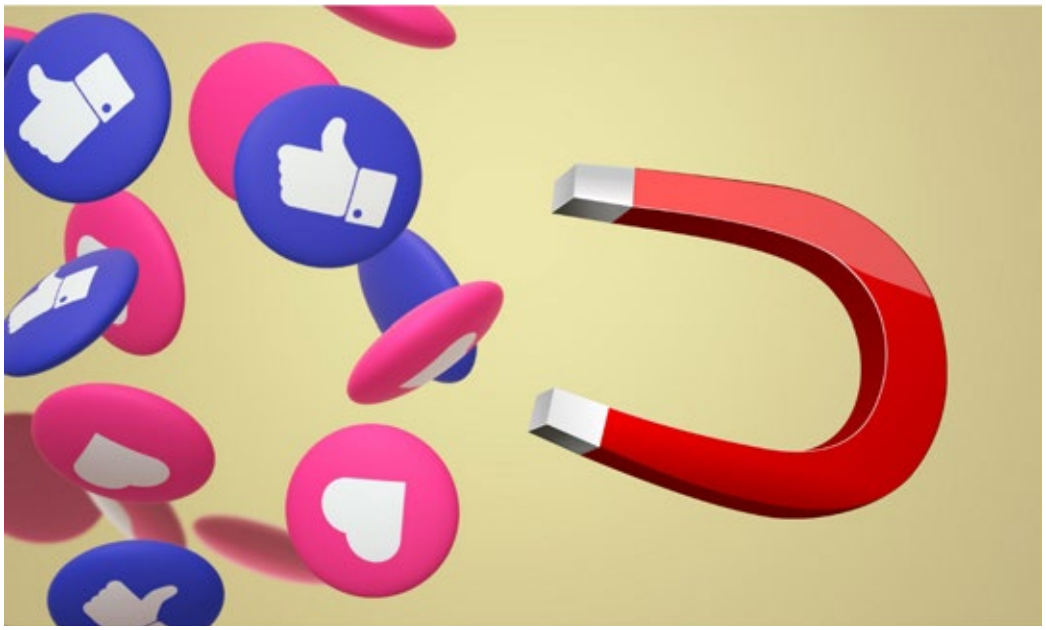
If your online store operates through an app, this objective can really boost app downloads. Just make sure your app is connected; if it's not, your ads will automatically focus on getting link clicks instead.

The goal of the App promotion objective is to display ads to audiences interested in your app, encouraging them to proceed with app downloads or sign-ups.

Sales

Find people likely to purchase your goods or services.

You can use the sales objective to reach people most likely to make a purchase, such as through an e-commerce site. You can also optimize for other actions, such as adding an item to the cart.



To conclude, setting the right Facebook ad objectives is critical to any successful marketing campaign. By choosing the right objective, you can ensure that the right people see your ads and that you are measuring the right metrics to track your success.

When choosing an objective, it is essential to consider your business goals and the stage of the buying cycle your target audience is in. For example, starting out, you may want to focus on awareness campaigns to build brand awareness. Once you understand your target audience well, you can move on to traffic campaigns to drive people to your website or app. And if you are ready to generate leads or sales, you can use the leads objective.

It is also important to measure the right metrics to track your success. You should always have clear goals and KPIs to measure the success of your campaigns and constantly track them.

By choosing the right Facebook ad objectives and tracking the right metrics, you can ensure that your marketing campaigns are effective and that you are getting a return on your investment.

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PLACEMENTS OF FACEBOOK ADS

4. PLACEMENTS OF FACEBOOK ADS

The places where you can run your ads are called Placements. Depending on the objective you choose when you create your campaign, your ads can appear on Facebook, Messenger, Instagram, and Meta Audience Network. Your ad type and settings determine available placements. Not all placements are available for every ad.

You can opt for automatic placement or manual placement. If you choose to select the manual options, you have multiple options to choose from. You can use the Devices dropdown menu to limit your placements to Mobile or Desktop. You can also choose to turn off Placements by deselecting the boxes from Facebook, Messenger, Instagram, or Audience Network.

Many placements are available across Meta, so let's look at it.

Feeds

- Facebook Feed: Your ads appear in the desktop Feed when people access the Facebook website on their computers. Your ads appear in the mobile Feed when people use the Facebook app on mobile devices or access the Facebook website through a mobile browser.
- Instagram Feed: Ads run in the mobile app, on desktops, and the mobile web.
- Instagram profile feed: Your ads will appear within the feed view of public Instagram profiles of people 18 and up. Meta's delivery system will place your ads in profiles where they will likely perform best.
- Facebook Marketplace: Your ads appear on the Marketplace home page or when someone browses Marketplace in the Facebook app.
- Facebook video feeds: Your video ads appear between organic videos in video-only environments in Video and Facebook Feed.
- Facebook right column: Your ads appear in the right column on Facebook. Right column ads only appear to people browsing Facebook on their computers.
- Facebook Business Explore: Your ads appear in Facebook Business Explore when someone taps on a business post header or comments in a mobile Facebook Feed.
- Instagram Explore: Your ads appear in the browsing experience when someone clicks on a photo or video.
- Instagram Explore home: Your ads appear as a tile in the Explore grid with other recommended content.
- Messenger inbox: Your ads appear in the Home tab of Messenger.

Stories and Reels

- Facebook Stories: Your ads appear in people's Stories on Facebook.
- Instagram Stories: Your ads appear in people's Stories on Instagram. Ads run in the mobile app, on the desktop, and the mobile web.
- Messenger Stories: Your ads appear in people's Stories on Messenger.
- Instagram Reels: Your ads appear in the Reels tab on Instagram.
- Facebook Reels: Your ads appear in the Reels tab on Facebook.

In-Stream Ads for Videos and Reels

- Facebook in-stream videos: Your ads appear in video on demand and in a select group of approved partner live streams on Facebook.
- Ads on Facebook Reels: Reach people with banner or video ads as they watch Reels.

Search

- Facebook search results: Your ads appear next to relevant Facebook and Marketplace search results.
- Instagram search results: Your ads appear in the search results when people enter a keyword search term into the search bar in the Instagram app.

Messages

- Messenger sponsored messages: Your ads appear as messages to people who have an existing conversation with you in Messenger.

Apps and Sites

- Audience Network native, banner, and interstitial: Your ads appear on apps on Audience Network.
- Audience Network rewarded videos: Your ads appear as videos people can watch in exchange for a reward in an app (such as in-app currency or items).

CREATION OF FACEBOOK ADS

5.1. SETTING UP

The main interface for Facebook ads is Ads Manager, which is accessible at the following link: www.facebook.com/business/. At the top right corner, there's an icon titled "Start now," which leads directly to the adverts/ interface.

It's essential to know the hierarchy of Facebook ads, so before continuing with creating ads, we'll explain that first:

Campaign

At the campaign level, we define the ultimate goal of adverts, e.g., page likes, boost posts, and website conversions. All ads created in that campaign must have the same purpose. If you want to promote your Facebook page and posts published on your Facebook page and your website, you'll have to create three different campaigns.

Ad set

On the second level, we define the target audience, budget for our ads, and placements. Ad Sets are created within campaigns (basically, campaigns consist of various Ad Sets). All ads created in a certain Ad Set will target the same target audience, have the same budget and payment method, and be positioned in the same places on Facebook.

Ad

Each Facebook ad can have its own picture and text, no matter which campaign or ad set it belongs to.

To summarize, on the advert level, we define the creative part of ads and place them into Ad Sets, which define the target audience, budget, and positioning. Moreover, apart from Ad Sets, we have Campaigns with the same goal. For example, six adverts (with different pictures and text in the description) were placed in the Ad Set to attract fans to the Facebook page, which defined the target audience as females aged 18-30, with ads shown only in News Feed. Considering our goal is to attract new fans, we initially defined this as a page-like campaign. Please note that we'll show you how to create a Page Like ad campaign, but the process is the same for website clicks ads, Post Promote ads, Retargeting ads, or any other kind of possible Facebook adverts.

5.2. TARGETING YOUR AUDIENCE

We've already mentioned that Facebook advertising allows you to target your audience admirably. We'll show you some examples of how this works and explain your options. Still, firstly, we must emphasize it's not necessary to use all available options and to really narrow down your audience (even though that can be done with just one option as well) because the price of your advert will be high. On the other hand, it's not good to have an audience that's too wide because then your advert will be shown to those who might not be among your target audience, and then they'll click on your advert and spend your budget. The best option is to find the optimal combination, which you'll do if you define your audience distinctly and directly among all possible options.

While targeting your audience, Facebook offers these options:

Custom Audiences

A special group that you've created using Ads Manager. Usually, the data gathered here is from people who participated in some contest on your page, such as website visitors. This option helps connect multiple online channels for promotion or retargeting. This group is created by clicking "Audience" in the Ads Manager menu. You'll be offered a few sections: Custom Audience – visitors of some website, a list of users who installed a specific app, etc. You can target users who have already expressed interest in a particular offer. A Lookalike Audience creates a new group of people similar to some previously created audience. In contrast, Saved Target Group creates your audience based on the parameters visible below, which you can apply to any campaign or ad.

Location

Defining country, but also targeting even more precisely by choosing regions, counties, and cities in certain countries.

Age

Defining the age group of your audience.

Gender

Defining the sex of your target audience.

Language

Targeting your audience based on the languages they speak.

Demographic

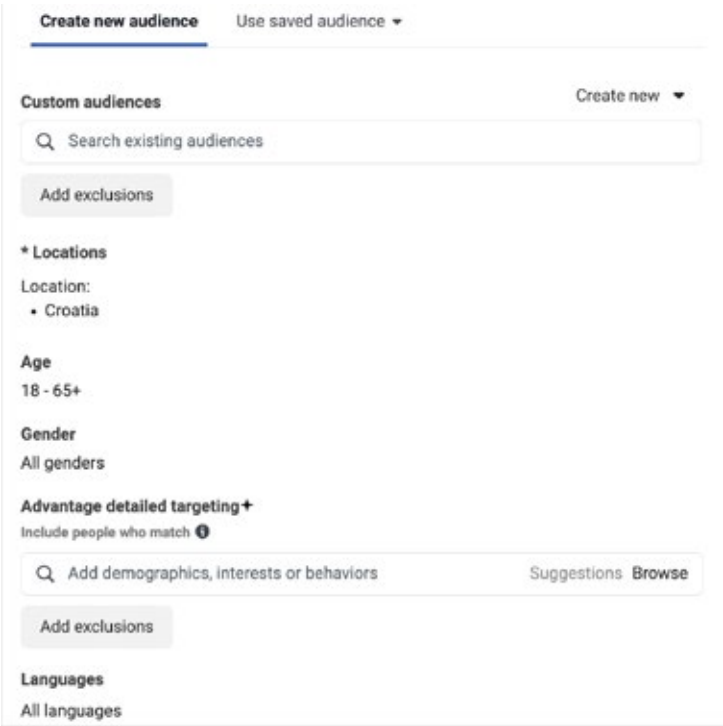
Defining your audience based on their relationship status, education level, employment, ethnicity, generation, parenthood, and any other parameters that define their everyday life (e.g., are they living outside their hometown, have they been newlyweds, have they made any career changes recently, etc.).

Interest

Contains different categories of personal interest that Facebook registered.

Behaviour

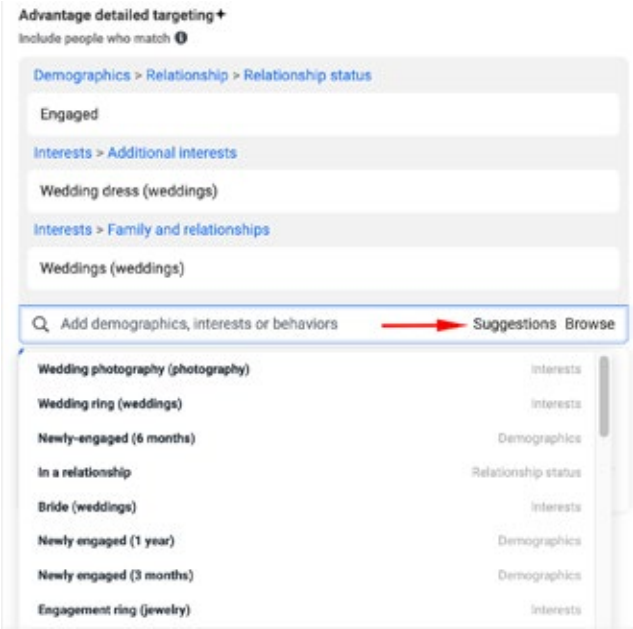
Offers different targeting options based on customers' behaviors or activities, such as their plans for future travels.

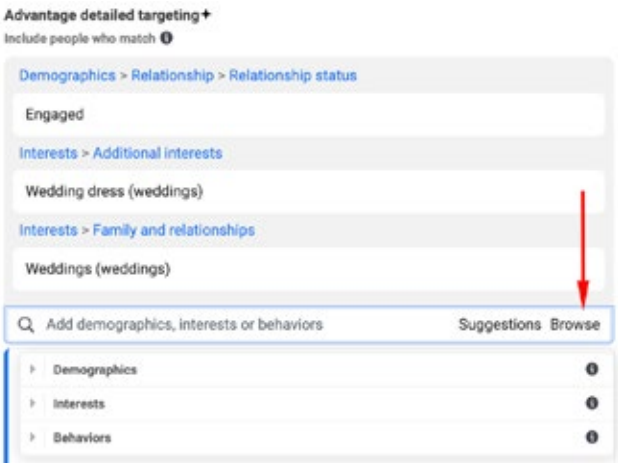


The targeted audience will be specific for each advert campaign, but in any case, it's important to remember to define it correctly so that your adverts can be shown to people who want to see them.

Let's say you're a small business owner of a wedding shop, and you're just trying to position yourself in the market. So, how would you target your audience based on demographics and their interests and behaviors? Thanks to Facebook's detailed targeting, which uses these options quite easily.

Facebook's targeting allows you to target engaged people, even those who got engaged 3 or 6 months ago, those in a relationship, or even married ones, which is all relevant for this example. Also, you can add interests such as wedding dresses or photography because people who previously expressed interest in those are more likely to be interested in your services as a wedding shop owner.





If you're not sure which targeting options to include, you can click on Suggestions, and Facebook will show options related to the ones you already selected. Alternatively, you can click on the Browse button, and Facebook will help you out with sections on Demographics, Interests, Behaviours, and even additional categories, so all you have to do is click on those that are relevant to your adverts.

If you plan to use this targeting more often, Facebook allows you to save it. That way, you'll save time and won't have to choose these targeting options whenever you want to create a new ad.

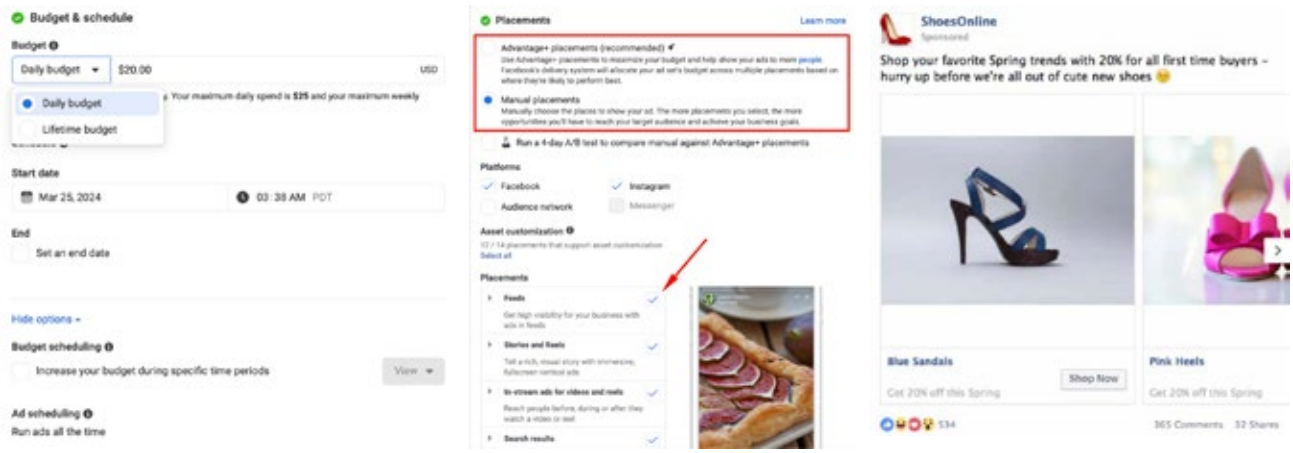
5.3. DEFINING BUDGET AND PLACEMENT

The administrator of adverts has to track what he gets for invested money, paying attention to data such as the price of Like on the page, cost of clicks on an advert, how many users will potentially see this advert, how many users clicked on an advert, what the average price of advert clicks or Likes on the page is. When creating an advert, you're offered options to define the budget on the Ad Set level. That budget can be defined daily or for a whole advertising period - lifetime budget, where you can choose a specific start and end date and hour of advertising with an estimate of how much money you will spend.

After defining the budget, schedule of your ads, and the people you want to target, you can select placements where you want your ads to show. As mentioned, you can select automatic (advantage+) or manual placements. Choose on which platforms and devices you want your ads to show.

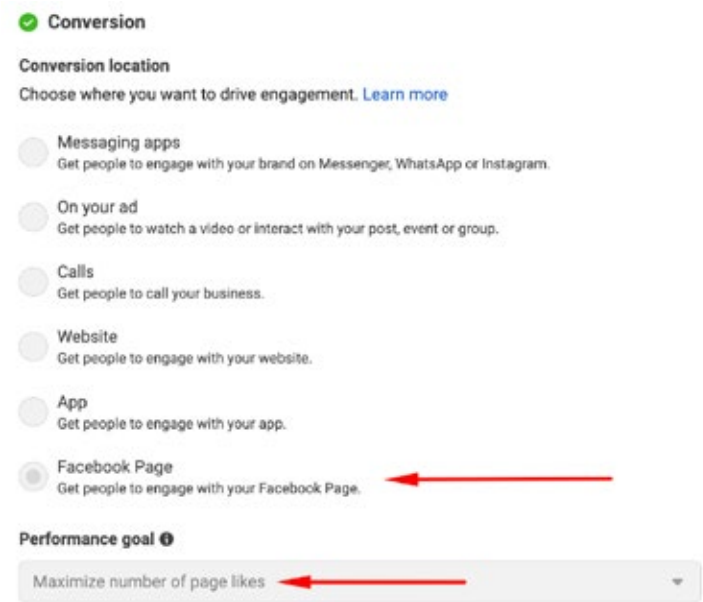
The most amusing part of the Facebook advertising process is the creative part, where you need to choose the format and general look of your final ad.

You can choose various options, such as a carousel, a single image, a video, a collection, or a slideshow. It's essential to select the correct format because you don't want to send out the wrong message, but also you want it to be visually appealing to Facebook customers. Let's say you own a webshop and sell shoes online. The carousel option would be perfect for your Facebook ad to showcase up to 10 different shoe styles you are selling, with a witty caption and carefully thought targeting and URL link leading users to your webshop, you got yourself a very successful Facebook ad.



5.4. CREATION OF FACEBOOK ADS TO DRIVE NEW LIKES TO THE PAGE

To make a Page likes campaign, you need to select Engagement as the campaign objective, and on the Ad set level, you need to choose the conversion location – where you want to drive Engagement. In this case, we want people to engage with our Facebook page, so we selected Facebook Page, and for the performance goal, we chose Maximize the number of page likes. That way, Facebook will try to deliver ads to the right people to help us get more Page likes at the lowest cost.

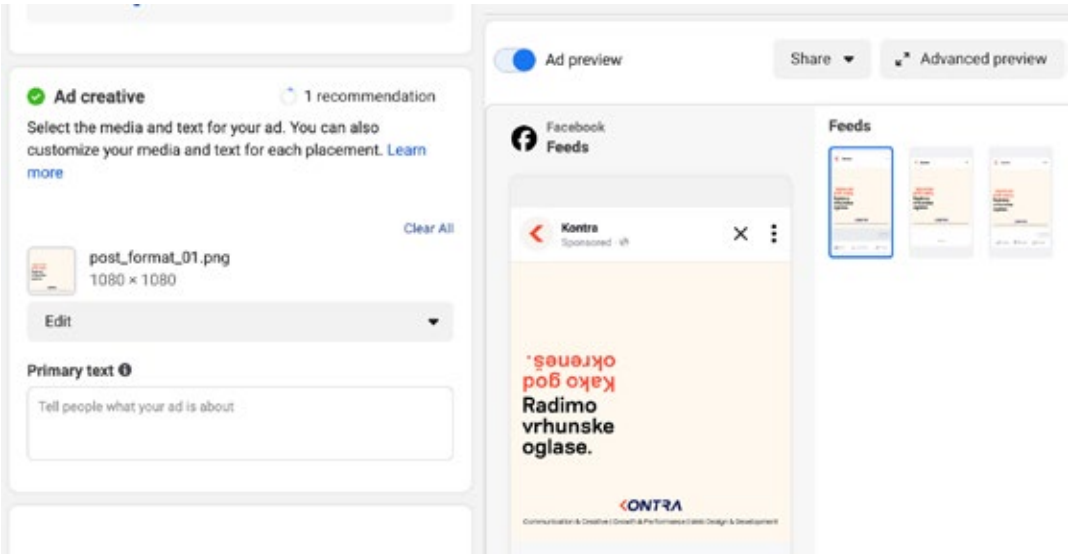


After choosing the Facebook page for which you'll be making ads, you define a target audience and payment method. And then, we move on to the creative part of your ads.

In a visually driven platform like Facebook, selecting eye-catching visuals is crucial for ad success. Use high-quality images or videos relevant to your message and capture attention while maintaining a consistent brand image. With Facebook's wide range of ad formats, choosing the suitable format that best suits your campaign goals is vital. Whether it's a single image, video, slideshow, or collection ad, ensure it aligns with your objectives and delivers your message effectively.

It is important to create compelling Facebook ads that grab your audience's attention not only with great visuals but also with engaging ad copy. The success of your Facebook ads largely depends on the copy you write. Craft compelling, concise, benefit-driven ad copy that speaks directly to your target audience. Use persuasive language that resonates with their needs and desires.

Add an image you want to use and write primary text to tell people what your ad is about. Meta text recommendation for primary text is 125 characters.



When you're thinking about the text of your advert, remember that an average Facebook user sees hundreds of ads daily, online and offline. That's why it's necessary to ensure your ad is different, unique, and interesting to stand out from the other adverts. For example, if we wanted to create an advert for dentist services, we could write "We offer the best dentist service...", but by spicing things up a bit, changing the concept, and communicating the message directly to the customer, we'll write "Would you like to have a beautiful smile?". This increases our chances of gaining more attention from our target audience. Naturally, these adverts can be changed later and adapted as many times as you want. The key thing is to play with your ads, emphasizing all the advantages users will get or gain, the unique qualities of your product/service, and special offers such as discounts, sales, etc.

The idea that short copy is always better isn't accurate across the board. For example, say you're advertising a high-ticket item or service to people unfamiliar with your solution. You may need a longer explanation of benefits and features to convince them to click to your website or buy. So, think about what you're advertising and to whom, and test longer and shorter variations of your copy to see what performs best.

It's essential to test your ads and trigger reactions from the page users to finally figure out suitable adverts that work for your target audience. Also, don't forget about your competition. Study them closely, see what they are doing, check their strategies, and see what they are doing on their pages so that, ultimately, you can do better!

It should be pointed out that creating an advert that helps you drive more customers and get more likes doesn't mean the end of your campaign. By clicking on your advert, the user is trying to gather as much information as possible. That important information should be visible right away on the cover of your Facebook page, special tab, album, and posts on the page.

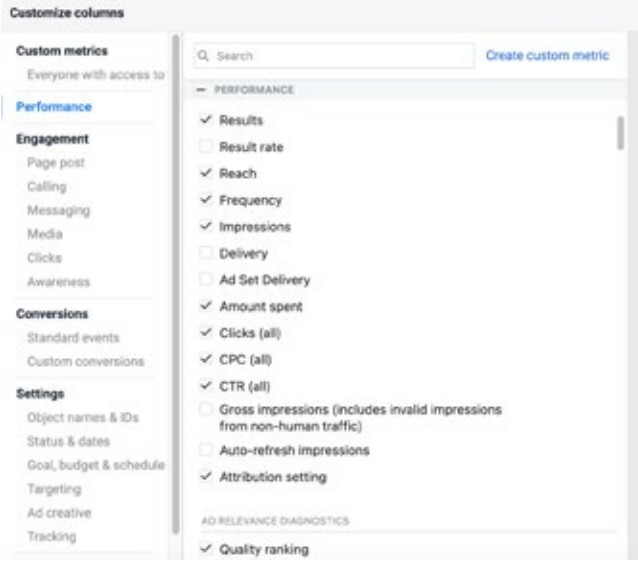
5.5. ANALYZING RESULTS OF FACEBOOK ADVERTISING

It all begins with your KPIs (Key Performance Indicators). Facebook is such a robust advertising platform that there is a ton of data to examine, and you need to pick the right metrics to focus on.

That's why Facebook provides several preset options for the most popular types of campaigns, so only the relevant metrics are displayed, and the rest are filtered out.

Additionally, all campaign types have some basic key metrics that should be included in every report. These include metrics such as Budget, Amount Spent, Reach, Impressions, and CPM.

If you are unsatisfied with Facebook's preset options, you can create your own custom column list by clicking on Customize Columns and selecting which metrics you would like to add to the report.



You can also add relevant breakdowns if you want to analyze further. Breakdowns are additional dimensions for data analysis, such as placements, dates, regions, etc.

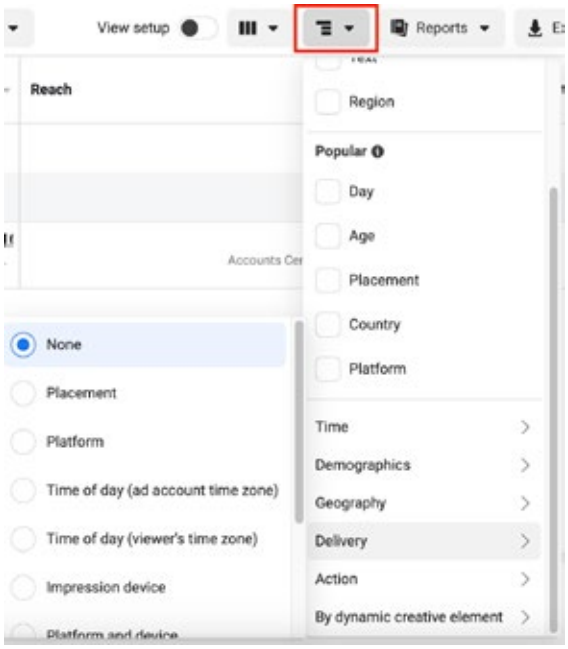
To do so, you can click on the "Breakdown" drop-down and choose your preferred breakdown. Note that, in some cases, you can't combine multiple breakdowns simultaneously, so choose wisely.

This is an essential step since this will give your data an added level of granularity, which will help you find patterns you might've easily missed otherwise.

Let's go through some of the metrics you should pay attention to.

Impressions

Impressions are the number of times your ads were on screen in front of your audience. The more impressions your ad receives, the higher your brand awareness is.



However, don't confuse impressions with reach:

Impressions are the total number of times your ad has been seen;

Reach is the total number of people who have seen your ad.

Let's say one person saw your ad five times. That means they got five impressions but only one reach.

You also want to look at impressions across publishing platforms to know where your ads appear most frequently.

Frequency

Frequency is the average number of times a person has seen your ad.

This is an especially important metric to measure if you have a very narrow, targeted audience.

While people often need to see an ad multiple times before converting, if they have seen it 10+ times, you're likely oversaturating your audience and need to expand your reach.

Keep an eye on frequency, but remember that you probably aren't oversaturating your audience if your conversion rate remains high.

Link Clicks

Link clicks are the total number of times people have clicked your ad's link.

Clicks are one of the key Facebook ad metrics confirming that your target audience is interested in your offer.

CTR

CTR (Click-through Rate) is the number of clicks compared to the number of impressions.

You may see 100 clicks and think your ads perform well. However, if your total number of impressions is 100,000, then those 100 clicks won't seem as impressive.

This is where click-through rates come into your Facebook Ad reports. CTR is calculated by dividing total clicks by impressions. You can't look at clicks alone—you must compare them to impressions to really evaluate how engaging your ads are.

Results

Results are the total number of times your campaign received its desired outcome.

This is arguably the most important metric, and it will vary depending on the type of Facebook Ads campaign and the business goal you have set.

Results will typically be a conversion metric, such as website purchases or leads. However, if you're running a brand awareness campaign, you may have traffic or impressions as your target result rather than lead generation or sales.

Cost per Result

Cost per Result measures how much each desired result (or action) costs and is measured by the formula: Total Ad Spend / Number of Results.

This metric is most similar to "Cost Per Action" or CPA on other PPC channels. Your campaign's result (or action) could be anything from a new signup, a sale, or a form submission, depending on your campaign's goals.

Spend

Spend is the total amount your ads cost for the selected period.

It is necessary to keep an eye on spending to be sure you are within budget, but you also need to monitor other cost metrics (like Cost Per Result and ROAS) to ensure you generate positive returns.

Roas

ROAS (Return on Ad Spend) is the amount of revenue the company receives for every $1 invested into ads and is one of the key metrics to understand if you have a successful Facebook Ads campaign.

The formula to calculate ROAS is Revenue / Ad Spend.

TO CONCLUDE

Facebook ads give us plenty of options for reaching our targeted audience uniquely and creatively. There's one golden rule: create multiple ads and check results after a few days to see which ads aren't working so we can cross them out and focus on those that give us the desired results. If necessary, this process should be repeated all the time. You can find specific campaigns where ads weren't deleted for weeks (there are even cases when an ad is intact for months and still delivers great results). Still, on the other hand, there are some campaigns where it's necessary to create new adverts daily to find the best one for your campaign. Tracking novelties in Facebook advertising, testing different options, continuously working on advertising, setting the right goals, and other online parameters that impact the results of adverts will get you your desired results.

Simplicity, meaning, goals, and creativity are key elements to successful advertising, but it's important to point out once more that your campaign doesn't end there after creating an ad!

By

KONTRA

with love.

https://kontra.agency/